

the needs of consumers, and thought, why don't we make a product that is as good as these international brands, gives the durability that Indians want, and make them sound as per Indians preferences with heavy bass and loud sound output? We even gave the products a funkier and more aspirational look," says Mehta, who co-founded boAt along with Gupta. A notable innovation was earphones with tangle-free flat cables that enamoured many customers, and brought many word-of-mouth customers to the brand. While that's how they started, they've come a long way since then, learnt a lot along the way, and kept on building the brand. "We didn't want to be the most expensive brand, nor the cheapest. We wanted to position ourselves in between," he says.

It comes as no surprise then that with these guiding principles, boAt has emerged as the second largest brand in the global wearables market, comprising everything from headphones to earphones and even

smartwatches, per the International Data Corporation (IDC) Worldwide Quarterly Tracker Q3CY2022 report. Not only that, the firm has also led in both the hearables and wearables categories in India for the past two years. While boAt's journey began with an initial capital of just ₹30 lakh, it had clocked revenues of an impressive ₹4,000 crore by FY23-end.

While Gupta and Mehta were setting up boAt, many others were building other brands in India such as Boulton, Noise, pTron, Fire-Boltt, etc. Together, they have orchestrated a paradigm shift in the country by establishing their dominance over India's wearables market. Incidentally, this is in stark contrast to the country's smartphone market, where not even a single Indian brand has a significant presence.

"India-based vendors have edged ahead by being early to the market and offering affordable but good quality/specification devices compared to China-based vendors or smartphone players. They

PLAYERS

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(Registered entity: Nexxbase Marketing)

● YEAR FOUNDED: **2014**

● FUNDING/EQUITY RAISED TILL DATE: **Bootstrapped**

● PRODUCT CATEGORIES: **Smartwatches and TWS**

● DISTRIBUTION: **Online: 80 per cent; offline: 20 per cent**

● KEY MARKETS: **India**

● GLOBAL MARKETS: **NA**

● SHARE OF MANUFACTURING IN INDIA: **95 per cent+**

● TEAM STRENGTH: **400+**



AMIT KHATRI (left)
Co-founder

GAURAV KHATRI
Co-founder



● YEAR FOUNDED: **2014**

● FUNDING/EQUITY RAISED TILL DATE: **₹32 crore raised by parent company Palred Technologies from Mathew Cyriac in 2022**

● PRODUCT CATEGORIES: **Smartwatches and TWS**

● DISTRIBUTION: **Online and offline**

● KEY MARKETS: **India**

● GLOBAL MARKETS: **Plans to enter the UAE and South American markets**

● SHARE OF MANUFACTURING IN INDIA: **Around 65 per cent**

● TEAM STRENGTH: **500+**



AMEEN KHWAJA
Founder & CEO

SOURCE COMPANY, BT RESEARCH